MONTHLY UPDATE

Cybersecurity: monthly update, September – October 2026

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> *31 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

ALGERIA · BENIN · BURKINA FASO · CAMEROON · CAPE VERDE · CHAD · COMOROS · EQUATORIAL GUINEA · ESWATINI · ETHIOPIA · GABON · GHANA · KENYA · LIBERIA · LIBYA · MALAWI · MAURITANIA · MAURITIUS · MOZAMBIQUE · NAMIBIA · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SENEGAL · SEYCHELLES · SIERRA LEONE · SOUTH AFRICA · TANZANIA · TOGO · TUNISIA · UGANDA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

State media reports a security operations centre and a network operations centre monitoring the national digital infrastructure round the clock, with no date, operator or incident figure.

Benin

Information-security officers from public and private institutions constituted a professional club on 26 September, adopting statutes and electing an 11-member board, with the aim of pooling expertise, training members and sharing lessons from incidents in confidence. The national digital investigations centre opened complaint points at Porto-Novo, Abomey and Parakou, in police premises, so that personal-data breaches and digital offences can be reported outside Cotonou.

Burkina Faso

What the testing is against is now measured on two series that do not sit together. The cybercrime unit puts reported loss at about FCFA 1.7bn in 2025 and FCFA 906,123,245 in the first half of 2026 on more than a thousand complaints in that half year, while an August account of the same unit's figures gives 6,367 complaints and FCFA 1.872bn of losses for 2025. The unit also equipped an audiovisual studio to produce educational content on digital risks, with deconstructing false information central to its remit.

Cameroon

The gap between the governing statute and the threat it governs was measured from outside government. A policy institute's brief puts cyberattacks up 156% between 2020 and 2023, financial losses from digital fraud above US$45m over the same period, and the national ICT agency's cybercrime unit at 23% of its establishment, and argues that cybersecurity belongs in the national development strategy as industrial policy rather than as a compliance obligation. The figures are the institute's own, with no underlying series or agency return held — which is itself part of its case.

At a national cyberspace-security forum opened in Yaoundé on 29 September, co-hosted with the Russian embassy, the national ICT agency reported 17,500 cybercrime complaints in 2025 with 5.8 billion FCFA of declared losses, and, since January 2026, 21,280 compromised machines, 39 attacks on public-administration websites and 5,369 vulnerabilities across 150 scanned websites. It cited a March 2026 ransomware attack that halted half of a public body's systems and cut its email for nearly a month.

Cape Verde

On 8 September the national postal operator warned customers about fraudulent messages from people impersonating its staff, asking recipients to click a link that is not its own. No message volume, loss figure or referral to a response body is published.

Chad

The women and early-childhood ministry banned the transmission of official correspondence, reports and decisions over WhatsApp, Messenger and other mobile applications, reported on 25 September, after finding that officials routinely did so; a breach is a disciplinary fault.

Comoros

Cybersecurity cooperation moved outside the usual partners. A Russian embassy delegation visiting from 8 to 12 September took up with the telecommunications and digital economy minister a memorandum on information security the two governments had already initialled, covering professional training, skills-building and the fight against cybercrime, with the Comorian side proposing a further document on training Comorian trainers. No signature date, text or funding is published, and the same visit prepared the opening of a Russian embassy in Moroni.

Equatorial Guinea

The Vice-President named the alleged members of a network leaking official documents of the Presidency of the Government, alleging that a registry official extracted several years of administrative files and handed over a hard drive on the pretext of a project to digitise the Presidency's archives. The account is the government's own, and no judicial finding is on file.

Eswatini

The ICT minister launched the 2026 cybersecurity awareness month on 1 October and said the ministry has begun reviewing the National Cybersecurity Strategy; no scope or timetable is published. The Director of Public Prosecutions said at the launch that her office has set up a Cybercrime Unit and trained prosecutors on the Computer Crime and Cybercrime Act 2022. The cybersecurity agency held the country's first national cyber drill, a multi-sector ransomware simulation facilitated by Lesotho's regulator.

Ethiopia

On 29 September the Information Network Security Administration and the central bank established a Financial Sector Cybersecurity Forum, jointly chaired by the two, for threat-information sharing, coordinated incident response and support to implementing cybersecurity policies and laws. Its membership and terms of reference are not published.

Gabon

The government raised its vigilance level after more than 900,000 intrusion alerts were recorded in sixty days, some judged very critical, following several attacks on national bodies, the digital economy minister calling on 7 September for protection to be treated as a permanent requirement. On 10 September ANINF answered that the figure shows a system able to detect threats and not 900,000 compromises. The window's dates and the number of alerts confirmed as incidents are not published.

On 7 October an accord between the digital infrastructure agency and a security vendor was reported to provide for a competence centre in Libreville for threat monitoring and skills transfer. No date or cost is given.

Ghana

The response team behind the licensing regime published a volume figure for the first time: it handled 3,363 incidents between January and June 2026 and ran vulnerability assessments across 25 critical information infrastructure institutions. There is no breakdown by type, sector or outcome, so it establishes how much came in and nothing about what happened to it.

On 24 September the Ghana Cybersecurity Industry Forum, the industry platform provided for under section 81 of the Cybersecurity Act, set out its mandate under an interim president, covering threat-intelligence sharing and incident-response coordination, and named a shortage of cybersecurity professionals as its main problem. No founding date or membership count is published. The central bank said on 1 October it is developing a fraud intelligence hub for financial institutions to share emerging fraud patterns; no launch date is stated. The cyber security authority put incidents recorded between January and July 2026 at 3,876, about 47% of them online fraud. The communications minister said 13 critical information infrastructure sectors are designated and about 200 institutions identified as owners, with compliance mandatory. The Cyber Security Authority said Ghana, not the United States Federal Bureau of Investigation, led the operation that arrested eight suspects and rescued 120 suspected trafficking victims at cybercrime centres in Greater Accra.

Kenya

The standards the new agency will enforce were put to the people who would have to work them. The technology authority tested the National Information Security Framework's audit, risk-management and certification mechanisms at a Nairobi workshop, to establish whether they are practical for national implementation ahead of certifying critical information infrastructure. Neither the framework text nor the certification criteria nor the list of infrastructure to be certified is published.

The government's scorecard reported the director-general recruited and deployed, board seats and technical posts still being filled, and the agency not yet fully operational, and two board members were then gazetted with effect from 11 September. The prosecutor's office meanwhile issued a reference guide setting out each offence under the cybercrimes Act with its elements, required evidence, sample charges and court application templates. The communications minister told the Senate that the national incident response centre's forensics laboratory had received more than 200 requests, most involving online abuse.

Liberia

Commentary reads its speech-adjacent offences at sections 15 to 20 against the constitution's free-expression article and the 2019 press-freedom Act.

Police confirmed in September that a man held over AI-generated images of the Vice-President was arrested under the Act. On 22 September a criminal court ordered him released from police custody on a habeas corpus petition, and the main opposition party said the same day it would ask the Supreme Court to rule on the Act's constitutionality. On 24 September, with no police officer appearing for the second time, the court found the state had not shown the case was lawfully sent to it and gave the police a last opportunity to justify holding him. No court has ruled on whether the conduct is an offence under the Act.

Libya

Work opened on 20 September on an integrated national cybersecurity plan, bringing together the heads of the cybersecurity and digital sovereignty authority, the information authority and the information security authority. No draft or timetable is published.

Malawi

The regulator put its own name to the methods a week later. It issued a public alert on rising digital fraud against mobile money and digital financial services, naming fake social cash transfer messages demanding a payment before assistance, failed-payment pretexts redirecting money to a second number, spoofed transaction alerts, fake competition prizes and takeovers of messaging accounts used to solicit money from contacts, and stating that bodies running social cash transfer programmes do not use ordinary messaging to request money from beneficiaries. The alert carries no incident count, loss figure or enforcement action, so the regulator is on record about the methods and not about their scale.

The regulator's own monitoring system came back under scrutiny. It installed a system to watch misinformation on Facebook, X and LinkedIn in January 2025 under a US$1.5m contract awarded 15 days earlier, eight months before the election, and civil-society letters, a presidency appeal and a rights-commission inspection that was abandoned left it running. No audit, retention rule or oversight body is published.

The regulator then gave the fraud a source: prisoners are behind up to 90 per cent of reported mobile-money scams, on its own figure, which leaves open how inmates reach handsets and networks at all.

Mauritania

An outside measure is the only dated position this month. The Internet Society puts the country's internet resilience at 43 per cent, with 3 per cent of the 1,000 most-visited websites served from a local server or cache and a security preparedness score of 39.33 on the 2024 global cybersecurity index. No national incident or response figure is held for the month. The project unit issued a national tender on 9 October 2026 to set up the national response team and a security operations centre for the administration's intranet, with bids due 17 November 2026.

Mauritius

Figures presented at a government workshop on 7 October put reported security incidents at 6,073 in 2025 against 5,221 in 2024, with cyberbullying up from 491 to 702 cases.

Mozambique

The minister said on 7 October 2026 that a national network of response teams now has teams in government, the cyber defence unit, the research network, the regulator, the telecoms sector and four provinces, with more being set up.

The communications minister put cyber incidents recorded in 2025 at about 39,600 and said the national cybersecurity strategy for 2026 to 2030 is still being updated.

Namibia

A private initiative opened alongside it. A Namibian technology company launched the Global Cybersecurity Initiative in Windhoek, a pan-African platform presented as connecting businesses, governments and innovators for commercial partnership rather than as an exhibition, opening across Namibia, Kenya, Botswana, Ghana, Nigeria, Zambia and South Africa with a stated target of 52 African countries by 2029. No government party, funding, governance arrangement or membership figure is published, and the US$4bn a year its chairman gave as Africa's cybercrime losses comes without a source.

The trust chain acquired its first link below the root, and the state is on both ends of it. The regulator accredited the home affairs, immigration, safety and security ministry as the country's first certification service provider, on a four-year accreditation announced in Windhoek on 1 September following the key-signing ceremony of 28 August. No second provider is on the record.

Nigeria

The national response team recorded a rise in high-impact incidents across sectors on 15 September, driven by phishing, ransomware, business email compromise and data breaches, and on 22 September warned of an escalation of Phobos ransomware attacks on managed cloud service providers whose clients include government agencies, banks and telecommunications firms, rating the damage critical and the probability high. Neither advisory publishes an incident count or names an affected organisation.

Rwanda

The prime minister said reported financial fraud complaints fell by about 30% in the second quarter of 2026 from 4,128 a year earlier, while digital transactions reached 3.1 billion in 2025. He said phone-based fraud and scams seeking confidential information remain. The central bank reported on 8 October 2026 that fraud cases fell to 2,879 in the second quarter of 2026 from 4,128 a year earlier, while only 3.6% of the Rwf471 million involved had been recovered.

Senegal

At the end of September the interior minister confirmed to deputies that the identity-file directorate had been attacked and said a general security audit had been engaged; no auditor, scope or completion date is given.

Seychelles

The national response team designed and delivered the third national cyberdrill itself for the first time.

Sierra Leone

The road safety authority disclosed an unauthorised intrusion into the systems used to produce vehicle licences, with five arrests. The communications ministry confirmed that 44 website addresses were hit on 25 September 2026 by unauthorised access to the system that administers the national internet domain, restored the same day.

South Africa

A provider that runs verification checks for Cell C, EasyEquities and Bidvest Bank reported a breach on 9 September.

After the insurance-software supplier breached in June reportedly paid a ransom, the attackers began extorting insurers directly and published data allegedly taken from one insurer on the dark web; a researcher confirmed it was public.

Fake traffic-fine messages quoting motorists' correct number plates led the road traffic infringement agency to consider investigating whether the national vehicle database had been accessed. The fines platform being impersonated says its own system was not breached.

Gauteng's e-Panic Button app left its database unsecured, exposing users' names, phone numbers, crime reports with images and GPS coordinates, and location histories, until the contractor fixed the flaws after a news outlet's alert on 21 September. On 29 September the provincial department said the flaw was patched and no personal information compromised. On 30 September the Information Regulator said it had received no breach notification from the department and would engage it; its own compliance assessment of the department had not been finalised. The capacity added was commercial, not state: a 40-desk security operations centre opened in Cape Town under a R55m investment, serving customers across Africa and internationally. The legislature's committees said after a joint meeting on 5 October 2026 that the department notified the Information Regulator only that morning, about two weeks after it was alerted, and could not say how many records were exposed.

Tanzania

August gave the national series the earlier account lacked. The regulator's director general later set the June 2026 count against 23,328 reported cases in September 2023, a 69% fall, and said awareness campaigns may have raised reporting.

Togo

The cybersecurity agency issued a call for expressions of interest on 27 August 2026 to build a national pool of cybersecurity professionals, in support of the 2024-2028 national cybersecurity strategy; applications close on 30 October.

Tunisia

Circular n. 5 of 2 September requires encrypted connections across official sites and platforms, mandatory renewal of security certificates, two-factor verification for administrator access, protection against traffic-saturation attacks and hosting on servers approved by the state; it bans the use of messaging apps and social media for exchanging official documents and requires regular audits, immediate reporting of incidents to the national cybersecurity agency and an end to the sharing of credentials between colleagues. It binds the administration rather than the wider economy, and no compliance deadline, audit schedule, budget or list of approved hosting providers accompanies it.

Uganda

The bankers' association counted 6,533 cyber and fraud incidents in the financial sector between January and August 2026, with UGX 24bn lost and a further UGX 68bn estimated at risk, naming wallet and peer-to-peer fraud and digital-channel compromise among the persistent threats. The Deputy Chief Justice said the judiciary is open to specialised handling of cyber and financial crime cases.

Zimbabwe

An industrial automation firm announced on 1 September 2026 the completion of a security and modernisation project on the control networks of a platinum mine, covering network architecture, segmentation and controlled access.

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